With a sense of déjà vu, I walk out to join Faf at the crease. It's a similar situation to that which we faced in Adelaide a year before, with the crucial difference being that the target against Australia back then was certainly beyond our reach, but this target set by the Indians is *almost* certainly too much, *not quite* certainly.

Faf and I agree to adopt a positive mindset, to go after anything loose rather than simply to block everything and play for time. History suggests we have little chance, but what does history know? Let's go and make history. We reach lunch at 237 for four, focused on surviving but still daring to dream.

Overs come and overs go. Zaheer Khan takes the new ball, searching for what could be the crucial breakthrough. He strays down leg, and I manage to feather-glance a boundary to fine leg. Next ball is a full toss, and I whip it past mid-wicket for four. Maybe, just maybe we can ... possibly. Ishant Sharma charges in and over-pitches, and I flick the ball for four. The next ball is too full, and I help the in-swinger to the boundary.

We bat past drinks. The Indian bowlers are starting to appear frustrated. The fielders look anxious. We reach tea at 331 for four. It's happening. It's possible. With six wickets still standing, we need 127 runs in the last session to secure one of our 'greatest Test wins', not one of theirs.

Faf reaches his century. I follow him into three figures soon after. The spectators are applauding every run. Extraordinary events are unfolding before their very eyes.

With 56 runs needed, I aim to steer another single down to third man, but the ball hits the inside edge of my bat and clatters into the stumps. I feel distraught – out, bowled for 103. Faf and I have added 205 runs for the fifth wicket. We are within sight of victory, but I had wanted to take us over the line.

JP Duminy hits a four and is then bowled. Vernon Philander joins Faf, and the runs flow until only 20 are needed from the last five overs. Faf drives towards mid-off and calls for a quick single. Rahane gathers,